MAEG3080 Fundamentals of Machine Intelligence

CIFAR-100 · Custom PyTorch SE-ResNet · Final Project

Rex Yim (Yim Fu Chong)
1155176974@link.cuhk.edu.hk

March 25, 2026

The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Goal

- Classify **CIFAR-100** with PyTorch *from scratch* (no pretrained weights)
- Compact **SE-ResNet** (squeeze-and-excitation attention)
- Pipeline: baseline $\rightarrow$ RandAugment finetune $\rightarrow$ Stage C (Mixup/CutMix/EMA)
- Final accuracy from course script `results.py`

Dataset (quick facts)

Scale
60k images · 32×32 RGB
100 classes · 600 / class

Splits
50k train / 10k test
Finetune: 90% / 10% val (seed 42)

Model

- `se_resnet`: residual blocks + **SE** channel attention
- Base width 32 · 2 blocks per stage · GAP $\rightarrow$ 100-way linear

Three-stage training

Stage A 4 epochs · basic aug · ∼33% test checkpoint

Stage B Init from Stage A · RandAugment · 30 epochs · val selection

Stage C From Stage B `best.pt` · Mixup/CutMix · EMA · lower LR

`scripts/iterate_from_stageb_stage_c_mixema.sh` · Colab · AMP

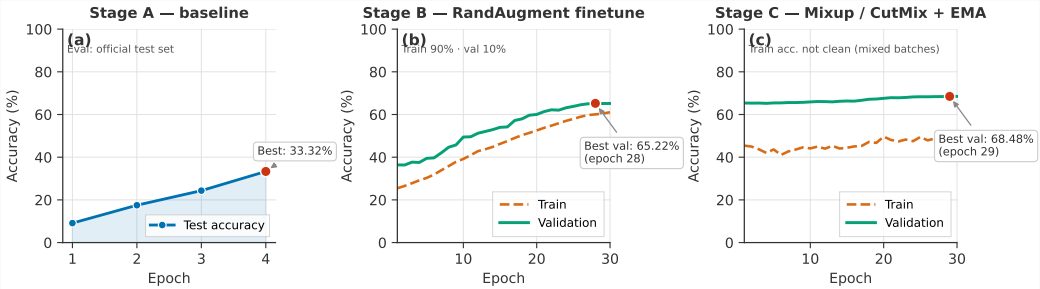
Results

Setting	Accuracy
Stage A baseline (4 ep., test)	$\approx 33.3\%$
Stage B official test	**65.17%**
Stage C official test	**68.14%**

Best model

Stage C checkpoint `sota_se_resnet_exp1/best.pt` · evaluated with `results.py`

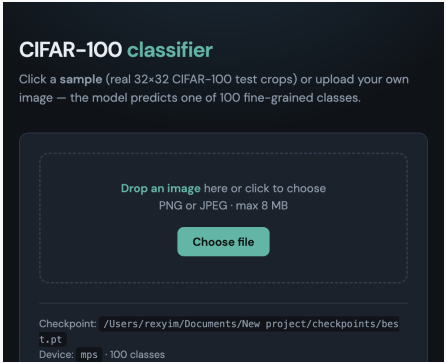
Training curves

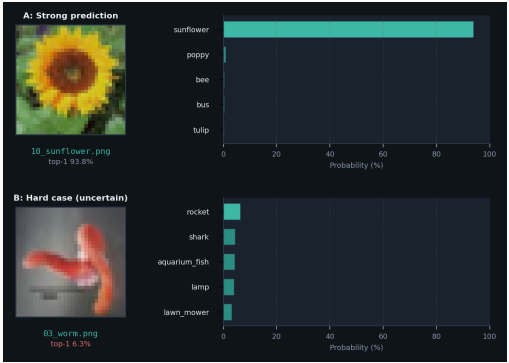


(a) Test · (b) train vs val · (c) Stage C (mixed-batch train acc. not directly comparable)

Interactive demo (local)

- `demo/` FastAPI: upload → top-k classes (SE-ResNet + `best.pt`)
- Run: `uvicorn demo.app:app --port 8765` · `http://127.0.0.1:8765`





Right: auto-picked from shipped samples — **strong** (highest top-1 conf.) vs. **weak** (lowest top-1); filenames under crops; same checkpoint as UI.

What worked

- Stable Stage A init before heavy augmentation
- RandAugment + longer schedule (Stage B $\approx$ 65% test)
- Stage C on top of Stage B: Mixup/CutMix + EMA ($\approx$ 68% test)

Challenges

- CIFAR-100 is fine-grained and small-input hard
- Long / huge models costly on free Colab
- SE-ResNet: faster iteration vs. lower ceiling than giant WRNs

Contribution

- Single author: data, model, training, Colab, report, slides
- Tools: Codex $\rightarrow$ Cursor · GPU on Colab

Takeaway

68.14% official test (Stage C) | **65.17%** (Stage B only)

Questions?